Flex Appeal Fantasy Football League Bylaws



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2026 League Members

Name	Paid
Jake Prosser	Yes
Matt Zacharias	Yes
Juan Rodriguez	Yes
Douglas Sulivan	Yes
Elijah Bruette	Yes
Brett Trana	Yes
Matt Atkinson	Yes
Marc Caballero	Yes
Vlad Barber	Yes
Derek Bock	Yes
Andrew Reed	Yes
Paul Bacon	Yes

1.0 League Breakdown

Number of Teams:	12
League Dues:	$100 buy-in
Scoring Format	0.5 PPR
Draft Date:	2026 Draft: September 6; 8:00pm CST/6:00pm PST
Positions:	QB, RB, RB, WR, WR, Flex 1 (WR/TE/RB) Flex 2 (WR/TE/RB), Flex 3 (WR/TE), IDP 6 Bench Slots, 1 IR Slot
Keeper Deadline:	Thursday, September 3; 8:00pm CST/6:00pm PST
Number of Keepers:	3 (ADP 1 or lower, ADP 3 or lower, ADP 5 or lower)
Waiver Wire Format:	FAAB Bidding [Free Agent Acquisition Budget]: 100
Schedule:	11 week regular season; playoffs weeks 12-17.
Trade Deadline:	Week 9

1.1 Overview of League

The Flex Appeal Fantasy Football League consists of 12 members, with Jake Prosser serving as commissioner. The primary goal of this league is to foster fun, friendly competition, with some good ol' trash talk on the side. And of course, win some money at the end of the season!

Active participation in the league's Sleeper chat is highly encouraged. It's the easiest way to stay connected. We will have a league group text thread to be used for important announcements. Participating in the group chat is a great way to build camaraderie and get to know your fellow league members. Alongside those means of communication, Commissioner Jake hosts the Flex Appeal Pod weekly during the season—be sure to give it a listen for insights, breakdowns, and the ever-influential Flex Rankings (power rankings).

The league requires a $100 buy-in at the start of the season. Failure to pay this fee may result in removal from the league. Colluding or sabotaging is strictly prohibited. Active participation and a genuine effort to win are expected from all members.
We understand that life can be busy and you might miss an update occasionally, but consistently leaving your roster empty or starting players on a bye week could result in removal from the league, **with your $100 buy-in forfeited**.

Winnings:
First Place: $850
Second Place: $250
Third Place: $100

1.2 Trades & Draft Picks

"Good Faith" Policy: Trading within the league should be made in good faith, either by taking a calculated risk on a player, by exchanging players to address positional depth and team needs, or to bolster the team's future with additional draft picks. *Do your research and think twice before accepting a proposed trade.*

Team managers are allowed to trade players on their rosters as well as draft picks they possess. Trades will be processed after a commissioner review period (24 hours at most); this time will be used for the commissioner to check that trades abide by league rules (no one is acquiring too many draft picks, etc). Upon review, the commissioner will process or deny the trade. Trades will not be subject to any sort of league veto process *under most circumstances.*

If there is a vocal portion of the league that feels a trade is unfair, the commissioner will begin the process of initiating a veto.
For a trade to be vetoed, **6 out of 10 league members** (members not involved within the trade) must agree that the trade undermines the competitive integrity of the league. If this threshold is met, the trade will be overturned. The commissioner also reserves the authority to reverse a

trade if it is found to involve collusion, tanking, or any form of sabotage. Sabotage is not limited to self-inflicted damage only; it can also include trades that harm the competitive balance of the league in certain instances. (aka the “You’re Being A Complete Moron With This Trade” Clause)

The commissioner will strive to avoid interfering with trades as much as possible. As adults who have invested both time and money into this league, the commissioner places trust in the integrity of the managers to make fair trades. However, in the event that a trade is deemed unfair, the outlined steps are in place to ensure transparency and maintain the competitive balance of the league.

VETO APPEAL PROCESS: If a trade is commissioner overturned/vetoed, the parties involved may submit an appeal.

- This appeal should include a written explanation from each manager involved in the trade, outlining the rationale behind the deal and how it benefits both teams.
- The appeal will be reviewed by a panel consisting of 3 neutral league members (not involved in the trade). These members will be chosen randomly to ensure fairness.
- The panel will review the trade and the appeals submitted. During this time, the panel may ask for further clarification from the managers if necessary.
- **Final Decision**: The panel will vote on whether to reinstate the trade or uphold the veto. A majority vote (2 out of 3) will determine the outcome. Once the decision is made, it will be final and cannot be further appealed.

Trading Rules

During the season (up to the trade deadline), managers may acquire additional draft picks through trades, provided that at no point does a team hold more than 18 total picks in any single draft.

Draft pick limits apply to the picks a team holds, not the picks it has acquired over time. In any single draft:

- No team may hold more than two 1st-round picks.
- No team may hold more than three total picks across the first two rounds (any combination, such as two 1sts and one 2nd, one 1st and two 2nds, or three 2nds).

A trade that would put a team over any of these limits will be rejected. These limits maintain competitive balance and prevent managers from stockpiling excessive top-tier draft capital.

Otherwise, in-season trades are relatively open. Feel free to trade player for player(s), player + pick for player, etc. There is no limit on how many trades you can do. Get creative in your quest to become champion!

A manager cannot go into a draft with *more* than **18 picks,** and cannot go *below* **11 picks**. Since rosters only hold **15 players**, any extras would require dropping players before the season officially begins anyways. The league trade deadline is **week 9**. With playoffs starting in week 12, be sure to plan any trades accordingly.

Any trades involving future draft pick assets: team managers must send commissioner Jake their $100 buy-in for that season's draft before it will be processed.

1.3 Keepers

Prior to the start of each season's draft, managers must select **three keeper players** from their roster. The keepers must abide within the following restrictions:

Keeper 1: ADP within round 1 or later (ADP = average draft position, per FantasyPros.com)
Keeper 2: ADP within round 3 or later
Keeper 3: ADP within round 5 or later

ADP will be frozen two weeks before the draft to allow managers to finalize plans.

Note that ADP 1 means the player is drafted on average within the first 12 picks (since we are a 12 team league). For example, a player with an ADP of 37 would be a 4th round ADP.

1.4 Draft Picks for the 2027 Season

Live from Sleeper as of Oct 13, 2026. Green = extra picks. Red = none. Blue = a single pick acquired via trade.

Rd	Matt Z	Jake	Lij	Doug	Juan	Paul	Brett	Vlad	Marc	Matt A	Derek	Andrew
1	0	2 (Own + Doug's)	1	0	2 (Own + Matt Z's)	1	1	1	1	1	1	1
2	1	1	1	1	0	1	1	1	2 (Own + Juan's)	1	1	1
3	1 (Marc's)	2 (Own + Matt Z's)	1	1	1	1	1	1	0	1	1	1
4	1	1	1	1	1	1	1	1	1	1	1	1
5	1	2 (Own + Lij's)	0	1	1	1	1	0	1	1	1	2 (Own + Vlad's)
6	1	1	1	1	1	1	1	1	1	1	1	1
7	1	1	1	1	1	1	1	1	1	1	1	1
8	1	2 (Own + Marc's)	1	1	1	1	1	1	0	1	1	1
9	1	0	1	1	1	1	1	1	2 (Own + Jake's)	1	1	1
10	1	1	1	1	2 (Own + Andrew's)	1	1	1	1	1	1	0
11	1	1	1	1	1	1	1	1	1	1	1	1
12	1	1	1	1	1	1	1	1	1	1	1	1
13	1	1	1	1	1	1	1	1	1	1	1	1
14	1	1	1	1	1	1	1	1	1	1	1	1
15	1	1	1	1	1	1	1	1	1	1	1	1
Tot	**14**	**18**	**14**	**14**	**16**	**15**	**15**	**14**	**15**	**15**	**15**	**15**

Caps (bylaw 1.2): no more than 18 picks, no fewer than 11, no more than two 1sts, and no more than three picks in rounds 1-2. Keepers do not consume draft picks. 15-round snake. Draft order not set yet; it will be determined by final 2026 standings per bylaw 1.5.

1.5 Draft Info

The draft will take place each year a few days before the NFL season kicks off. This timing allows us to get as close as possible to the start of the season, minimizing the impact of any preseason injuries on player selections. The FAFFL uses a **snake draft format**, and the order in which managers draft is determined by the following criteria:

- **Previous Year's Playoff Teams**: Draft spot is based on final playoff standings, with the higher-ranked playoff teams drafting later. (I.E. league winner drafts last)
- **Previous Year's Non-Playoff Teams**: Draft selection for non-playoff teams is determined by regular season standings; the team with the last-place finish in the regular season secures the first overall pick for the following draft, and so forth.

A "loser's bracket" (The Toilet Bowl) is held during the playoffs, where the losing team advances each round. This bracket does not impact draft position; however, it does determine the league's last place punishment (see Section 1.9).

Draft Time: As a league of 12 adults with busy work lives, families, and other obligations, we understand that scheduling can be challenging. While we will do our best to find a draft time that works for everyone, it's likely that some members may need to make sacrifices or adjust their schedules to participate.

Draft Time Conflicts: In the event that a manager is *completely* unable to attend the draft (an emergency situation, etc), they are able to opt out of the "buy-in" for that season. However, by doing so, they will also forfeit their eligibility to win any prize money at the end of the season*. If their team ends up winning the league, 2nd, 3rd, and 4th place finishers will receive the prize money.

*For the 2026 season, I (Commissioner Jake) am willing to front the buy-in in said scenario, and that manager can still be eligible for the prize money. Starting with 2027 this policy will go into effect.

1.6 Regular Season Format

The FAFFL does not divide teams into separate divisions or conferences. The regular season spans 11 weeks. At the end of Week 11, the top 7 teams in the standings advance to the playoffs, with the top seed receiving a bye in the first round. A detailed breakdown of scoring and points can be found within Sleeper.

Extra Game Each Week Against League Median
In addition to your weekly matchup, your team's score will also be compared to the league median score. If your score exceeds the league median, you earn a win, even if you lost your actual head-to-head matchup. This means each week, your record could reflect one win and one loss, two wins, or two losses. This feature adds an exciting dynamic to our league, ensuring that exceptional performances are rewarded, even in high-scoring games where you might otherwise be screwed out of a win due to an unlucky matchup.

Note that this is the *median* league score and not the *average* league score.

Waivers:
FAFFL uses the **Free Agent Acquisition Budget (FAAB) bidding system for waivers**. Here's how it works:

What is FAAB Bidding?
FAAB gives each manager a set budget (100 points) to use for acquiring players off waivers during the season. Instead of priority being determined by standings, managers will submit a "bid" for the player they want, specifying how many of their FAAB points they are willing to spend.

- The highest bid wins the player, and the corresponding points are deducted from that manager's budget.
- In the event of a tie (two or more managers bid the same amount), the player will go to the manager with the lower standings position at that time.
- If no one bids on a player, they can be picked up for **0 points** after the waiver period ends.

Each manager will start the season with **100 FAAB points** to spend throughout the season. It's up to you to manage your budget strategically, deciding how much to bid on each player. Once you've used all your points, you can no longer bid on players and must wait to claim unbid players for free. Spend your points wisely!

1.7 Postseason Format

The Flex Appeal Playoffs begin in Week 12. Each round of the playoffs span two weeks, with the highest *combined* score advancing.
Wild-Card: Weeks 12+13
Semifinals: Weeks 14+15
Championship: Weeks 16+17

In the first round, the 2nd through 7th seeds compete to advance to the semi-finals. The winners of the wild-card games advance to the semi-finals, with the lowest remaining seed playing against the 1 seed who had the bye week. The winners of these semi-final matchups advance to the championship game.

The winner of the championship round will be crowned the Flex Appeal FFL Champion and will take home the grand prize of $850. Second place takes home $250, while the winner of the third place matchup receives $100 (essentially, a free season of play).

For those who did not qualify for the playoffs, the Toilet Bowl playoffs provide a unique spin on the consolation bracket. In this format, the **losing** team advances each round. By the end of the playoffs, the league's "Sh*t King" is crowned as the biggest loser of the season. As mentioned previously, this bracket is just for fun and does not affect your final standing placement or drafting position. It does, however, determine who must complete the last place punishment (see section 2.0).

1.8 Breakdown of Scoring

Mostly standard offense; half point per reception scoring. Check Sleeper for a full breakdown, which will highlight any custom rules.

IDP Scoring (Individual Defensive Player)
IDP TD: 6 pts
Sack: 4 pts
Hit on QB: 1 pt
Interception: 4 pts
Fumble Recovery: 2 pts
Forced Fumble: 2 pts
Safety: 2 pts
Assisted Tackle: 0.5 pts
Solo Tackle: 1 pt
Tackle for Loss: 0.5 pts
Pass Defended: 2 pts

1.9 League Code of Conduct

Active Participation:
Active participation is expected throughout the season. This includes regularly updating your roster, engaging periodically in the league's text/Sleeper chats, and making a genuine effort to win each week. Consistently failing to set your lineup, starting players on a bye week, or generally neglecting your team could result in removal from the league, with forfeiture of your buy-in fee.
Respectful Communication:
Trash talk is a part of the fun, but it should remain respectful. Don't make things personal. We are here to enjoy some football and the camaraderie that comes with it, so let's keep the atmosphere mostly positive and enjoyable. If for some reason you have beef with another league member, handle it outside of league group chats.
Fair Play and Integrity:
Collusion, self-sabotage, or any attempts to manipulate the league for personal gain outside of the bylaws are strictly prohibited. All members are expected to uphold the integrity of the league, contributing to a fair and fun environment for everyone involved.
Commitment to the League:
The Flex Appeal Fantasy Football League thrives on the commitment and investment of its members. We seek to maintain a group of managers who are dedicated to the long-term success of the league. By following this code of conduct, we can ensure that the league remains enjoyable, competitive, and sustainable for years to come.
Notification of Departure:
As a matter of common courtesy, **please notify the league commissioners as soon as possible if there is any chance you may be unable or unwilling to return for the following season.** The earlier you can provide this information, the better. Giving advance notice allows the commissioner ample time to manage logistics. This includes addressing any traded draft picks, evaluating the current state of the departing team's roster, and reaching out to potential new league members.

2.0 Last Place "Punishment"

To keep the competitive spirit alive and discourage complacency if your squad did not reach the playoffs, the league will impose a consequence for the last-place finisher each season, aka the Toilet Bowl Champ. The last-place manager may choose one of the following options:

- **Financial Penalty**: Pay $100 to the fourth place finisher
- **Dare/Challenge**: Perform a humorous/embarrassing/savage league-agreed dare/challenge. Proof of completion must be shared with the group (video, picture, etc).

This should be accomplished no later than a week after the season ends. (*Failure to complete the punishment could result in removal from the league!*)

2.1 League History

2022 Winner: Jared Messinger [1x]
2023 Winner: Douglas Sullivan [1x]
2024 Winner: Douglas Sullivan [2x]
2025 Winner: Vlad Yagudayev [1x]
2026 Winner: TBD